

Supersize ME

In a country known for cooking slow and eating at leisure, quick and easy is the name of the game in today's kitchens

■ By Damayanti Datta

The clock hanging from Fatehpuri Masjid is handless. But one can tell it's lunch time in old Delhi. The history-laden bylanes of Chandni Chowk pulsate with a mélange of aroma and hungry customers. Nobody's thinking history though. They are busy dodging hawkers and rickshaws to please their palate: kebabs at Karim's, Karachi halwa at Ghanewala and nehari at Bismillah. Not the place you expect to find the long arm of capitalism. But look carefully. Between the latticed SBI tower and colonnaded

Baptist church, the golden arches of McDonald's peer incongruously. In the brave new world of globalisation, McBurgers are meeting ghee-drenched paranthas head-on.

It's a gastronomical revolution in a country where eating outside one's family, caste, kinship and community was frowned upon 60 years ago.

"What people eat, or don't eat, is determined by a complex interplay of social, economic, and technological forces," says master chef and author, Sanjeev Kapoor. Riding on the wings of prosper-

80%
is the rate at
which the instant
meals market
is growing
annually in India

PEDDLING A MEAL: A
McDonald's boy on his
delivery trail

